

Life, Liberty, and the Pursuit of Happiness in Christ

Jason P. Hayward

To my fellow citizens of the United States and to all lovers of liberty

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Introduction

In the United States, we have two national holidays that celebrate our liberty, the Fourth of July, or Independence Day, and Juneteenth National Independence Day. The latter commemorates the receipt of the news of the Emancipation Proclamation by Black slaves in Texas two and a half years after it was issued. It is right to say that individualism and independence are key values of our culture. Based on our Declaration of Independence, we also greatly value what we hold to be the unalienable right of citizens: "We hold these truths to be self-evident, that all men are created equal, that they are endowed by their Creator with certain unalienable Rights, that among these are Life, Liberty and the pursuit of Happiness."

As Christ followers who are also United States Citizens, we find our identity not mainly in being United States citizens but in our Lord and Savior, Jesus Christ. In truth, the pursuit of life, liberty and happiness apart from Christ drives us directly away from the same.

As such, this book reviews and stimulates thought on "Life, Liberty and the pursuit of Happiness" in the word of God, which finds its fulfillment as "Christ in you" (Colossians 1:27). Since truth is found in God's word to us, let us understand and pursue these good creations of God as they actually are and as they are actually found.

They are found in following our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ. He is Life. He has brought us liberty. The life, the liberty and happiness from God are ours when we actively cooperate with the indwelling Spirit of God to form the fullness of Christ in us. Let us also seek God's fullness within our churches and other local fellowships.

Chapter 1: Life

Our life as followers of Christ is Christ in us. Our belief in Jesus as the Son of God and our profession to follow Him yields eternal life, joining us directly to the Spirit of life. The indwelling Spirit is a source of quickening for ourselves and for the overflow of this life to others, as we are obedient to do God's word. Let us seek not only to be filled, but together to overflow with rivers of Christ's life.

Selected words in scripture

Live

H2421

Transliteration: châyâh

Pronunciation: khaw-yaw'

BDB Lexicon:

1. To live, have life, remain alive, sustain life, live prosperously, live forever, be quickened, be alive, be restored to life or health
 - a. (Qal)
 - i. To live
 1. To have life
 2. To continue in life, remain alive
 3. To sustain life, to live on or upon
 4. To live (prosperously)
 - ii. To revive, be quickened
 1. From sickness
 2. From discouragement
 3. From faintness
 4. From death
 - iii. (Piel)
 1. To preserve alive, let live
 2. To give life
 3. To quicken, revive, refresh
 - a. To restore to life
 - b. To cause to grow
 - c. To restore
 - d. To revive
 - iv. (Hilphil)
 1. To preserve alive, let live
 2. To quicken, revive
 - a. To restore (to health)
 - b. To revive
 - c. To restore to life

Also translated as alive, save, quicken, revive, life, recover

Live

H2416

Transliteration: chay

Pronunciation: khah'-ee

Root word: châyâh, H2421

BDB Lexicon:

1. Living, alive (adjective)
 - a. Green (of vegetation)
 - b. flowing, fresh (of water)
 - c. Lively, active (of man)
 - d. Reviving (of the springtime)
2. Relatives (noun masculine)
3. Life (abstract emphatic) (noun masculine)
 - a. Life
 - b. Sustenance, maintenance
4. Living thing, animal (noun feminine)
 - a. Animal
 - b. Life
 - c. Appetite
 - d. Revival, renewal
5. Community

Also translated as life, beast, alive, creature

Life

G2222

Transliteration: zōē

Pronunciation: dzo-ay'

Root word: From zao (meaning to live)

Thayer Lexicon:

1. Life
 - a. The state of one who is possessed of vitality or is animate
 - b. Every living soul
2. Life
 - a. Of the absolute fullness of life, both essential and ethical, which belongs to God, and through him both to the hypostatic "logos" and to Christ in whom the "logos" put on human nature
 - b. Life real and genuine, a life active and vigorous, devoted to God, blessed, in the portion even in this world of those who put their trust in Christ, but after the resurrection to be consummated by new accessions (among them a more perfect body), and to last for ever

Life

G5590

Transliteration: psuchē

Pronunciation: psou-khay'

Thayer Lexicon:

1. Breath
 - a. The breath of life
 - i. The vital force which animates the body and shows itself in breathing
 1. Of animals
 2. Of men
 - b. Life
 - c. That in which there is life
 - ii. A living being, a living soul
2. The soul
 - a. The seat of the feelings, desires, affections, aversions (our heart, soul, etc.)
 - b. The (human) soul in so far as it is constituted that by the right use of the aids offered it by God it can attain its highest end and secure eternal blessedness, the soul regarded as a moral being designed for everlasting life
 - c. The soul as an essence which differs from the body and is not dissolved by death (distinguished from other parts of the body)

Also translated as soul

Life

G979

Transliteration: bios

Pronunciation: bee'-os

Thayer Lexicon:

1. Life
 - a. Life extensively
 - i. The period of course of life
 - b. That by which life is sustained, resources, wealth, goods

Also translated as living

Living

G2198

Transliteration: zaō

Thayer Lexicon:

1. To live, breathe, be among the living (not lifeless, not dead)
2. To enjoy real life
 - a. To have true life and worthy of the name
 - b. Active, blessed, endless in the kingdom of God
3. To live, i.e. pass life, in the manner of the living and acting
 - a. Of mortals or character
4. Living water, having vital power in itself and exerting the same upon the soul
5. Metaphorically to be in full vigour
 - a. To be fresh, strong, efficient
 - b. As adjective active, powerful, efficacious

Also translated as live

Quicken

G2227

Transliteration: zōopoieō

Pronunciation: dzo-op-oy-eh'-o

Thayer Lexicon:

1. To produce alive, beget or bear living young
2. To cause to live, make alive, give life
 - a. By spiritual power to arouse and invigorate
 - b. To restore to life
 - c. To give increase of life: thus of physical life
 - d. Of the spirit, quickening as respects the spirit, endued with new and greater powers of life
3. Metaphorically, of seeds quickened into life, i.e. germinating, springing up, growing

Also translated as give life, make alive

Selected scriptures and questions for meditation

H2421, Châyâh, live

““The whole commandment that I command you today you shall be careful to do, that you may live and multiply, and go in and possess the land that the Lord swore to give to your fathers... And he humbled you and let you hunger and fed you with manna, which you did not know, nor did your fathers know, that he might make you know that man does not live by bread alone, but man lives by every word that comes from the mouth of the Lord.”

Deuteronomy 8:1, 3 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/deu.8.1-3.ESV>

“All the commandments which I command thee this day shall ye observe to do, that ye may live, and multiply, and go in and possess the land which the LORD sware unto your fathers... And he humbled thee, and suffered thee to hunger, and fed thee with manna, which thou knewest not, neither did thy fathers know; that he might make thee know that man doth not live by bread only, but by every word that proceedeth out of the mouth of the LORD doth man live.”

Deuteronomy 8:1, 3 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/deu.8.1-3.KJV>

- 1) Are we still expected to follow God's commandments?
- 2) How is it that we live by every word that comes from the mouth of the Lord?
- 3) In what ways does God quicken us?

“And the Lord listened to the voice of Elijah. And the life of the child came into him again, and he revived.”

1 Kings 17:22 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1ki.17.22.ESV>

“And the LORD heard the voice of Elijah; and the soul of the child came into him again, and he revived.”

1 Kings 17:22 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/1ki.17.22.KJV>

4) How is it that Elijah was able to restore life to a dead boy in this passage?

“The Spirit of God has made me, and the breath of the Almighty gives me life.”

Job 33:4 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/job.33.4.ESV>

“The Spirit of God hath made me, And the breath of the Almighty hath given me life.”

Job 33:4 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/job.33.4.KJV>

“I shall not die, but I shall live, and recount the deeds of the Lord.”

Psalms 118:17 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/psa.118.17.ESV>

“I shall not die, but live, And declare the works of the LORD.”

Psalms 118:17 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/psa.118.17.KJV>

5) What should we declare as long as we have life and breath?

6) Who has power to restore us to life and full health?

“Deal bountifully with your servant, that I may live and keep your word. My soul clings to the dust; give me life according to your word! Turn my eyes from looking at worthless things; and give me life in your ways. Behold, I long for your precepts; in your righteousness give me life! This is my comfort in my affliction, that your promise gives me life. Let your mercy come to me, that I may live; for your law is my delight. In your steadfast love give me life, that I may keep the testimonies of your mouth. I will never forget your precepts, for by them you have given me life. I am severely afflicted; give me life, O Lord, according to your word! Uphold me according to your promise, that I may live, and let me not be put to shame in my hope! Your testimonies are righteous forever; give me understanding that I may live. Hear my voice according to your steadfast love; O Lord, according to your justice give me life. Plead my cause and redeem me; give me life according to your promise! Great is your mercy, O Lord; give me life according to your rules. Consider how I love your precepts! Give me life according to your steadfast love. Let my soul live and praise you, and let your rules help me.”

Psalms 119:17, 25, 37, 40, 50, 77, 88, 93, 107, 116, 144, 149, 154, 156, 159, 175 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/psa.119.17-175.ESV>

“Deal bountifully with thy servant, That I may live, and keep thy word. My soul cleaveth unto the dust: Quicken thou me according to thy word. Turn away mine eyes from beholding vanity; And quicken thou me in thy way. Behold, I have longed after thy precepts: Quicken me in thy righteousness. This is my comfort in my affliction: For thy word hath quickened me. Let thy tender mercies come unto me, that I may live: For thy law is my delight. Quicken me after thy lovingkindness; So shall I keep the testimony of thy mouth. I will never forget thy precepts: For with them thou hast quickened me. I am afflicted very much: Quicken me, O LORD, according unto thy word. Uphold me according unto thy word, that I may live: And let me not be ashamed of my hope. The righteousness of thy testimonies is everlasting: Give me understanding, and I shall live. Hear my voice according unto thy lovingkindness: O LORD, quicken me according to thy judgment. Plead my cause, and deliver me: Quicken me according to thy word. Great are thy tender mercies, O LORD: Quicken me according to thy judgments. Consider how I love thy precepts: Quicken me, O LORD, according to thy lovingkindness. Let my soul live, and it shall praise thee; And let thy judgments help me.”

Psalm 119:17, 25, 37, 40, 50, 77, 88, 93, 107, 116, 144, 149, 154, 156, 159, 175 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/psa.119.17-175.KJV>

7) How does God quicken us? How does His word quicken us?

8) What does it mean to be quickened according to God’s word? In God’s way? In God’s righteousness? After His lovingkindness?

9) What does it mean to keep the testimony of God’s mouth? What are we to speak of as long as God gives us life?

Also see *Day 22: Life in the Word of God* from my book [“God’s Love Plan in Jesus and the Church: 40 Days in the Old Testament”](#)

““And when I passed by you and saw you wallowing in your blood, I said to you in your blood, ‘Live!’ I said to you in your blood, ‘Live!’”

Ezekiel 16:6 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/ezk.16.6.ESV>

“And when I passed by thee, and saw thee polluted in thine own blood, I said unto thee when thou wast in thy blood, Live; yea, I said unto thee when thou wast in thy blood, Live.”

Ezekiel 16:6 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/ezk.16.6.KJV>

“And he said to me, “Son of man, can these bones live?” And I answered, “O Lord God, you know.” Then he said to me, “Prophecy over these bones, and say to them, O dry bones, hear the word of the Lord. Thus says the Lord God to these bones: Behold, I will cause breath to enter you, and you shall live. And I will lay sinews upon you, and will cause flesh to come upon you, and cover you with skin, and put breath in you, and you shall live, and you shall know that I am the Lord.” So I prophesied as I was commanded. And as I prophesied, there was a sound, and behold, a rattling, and the bones came together, bone to its bone. And I looked, and behold, there were sinews on them, and flesh had come upon them, and skin had covered them. But

there was no breath in them. Then he said to me, "Prophecy to the breath; prophecy, son of man, and say to the breath, Thus says the Lord God: Come from the four winds, O breath, and breathe on these slain, that they may live." So I prophesied as he commanded me, and the breath came into them, and they lived and stood on their feet, an exceedingly great army. Then he said to me, "Son of man, these bones are the whole house of Israel. Behold, they say, 'Our bones are dried up, and our hope is lost; we are indeed cut off.' Therefore prophecy, and say to them, Thus says the Lord God: Behold, I will open your graves and raise you from your graves, O my people. And I will bring you into the land of Israel. And you shall know that I am the Lord, when I open your graves, and raise you from your graves, O my people. And I will put my Spirit within you, and you shall live, and I will place you in your own land. Then you shall know that I am the Lord; I have spoken, and I will do it, declares the Lord.'"

Ezekiel 37:3-14 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/ezk.37.3-14.ESV>

"And he said unto me, Son of man, can these bones live? And I answered, O Lord GOD, thou knowest. Again he said unto me, Prophecy upon these bones, and say unto them, O ye dry bones, hear the word of the LORD. Thus saith the Lord GOD unto these bones; Behold, I will cause breath to enter into you, and ye shall live: and I will lay sinews upon you, and will bring up flesh upon you, and cover you with skin, and put breath in you, and ye shall live; and ye shall know that I am the LORD. So I prophesied as I was commanded: and as I prophesied, there was a noise, and behold a shaking, and the bones came together, bone to his bone. And when I beheld, lo, the sinews and the flesh came up upon them, and the skin covered them above: but there was no breath in them. Then said he unto me, Prophecy unto the wind, prophecy, son of man, and say to the wind, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Come from the four winds, O breath, and breathe upon these slain, that they may live. So I prophesied as he commanded me, and the breath came into them, and they lived, and stood up upon their feet, an exceeding great army. Then he said unto me, Son of man, these bones are the whole house of Israel: behold, they say, Our bones are dried, and our hope is lost: we are cut off for our parts. Therefore prophecy and say unto them, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, O my people, I will open your graves, and cause you to come up out of your graves, and bring you into the land of Israel. And ye shall know that I am the LORD, when I have opened your graves, O my people, and brought you up out of your graves, and shall put my spirit in you, and ye shall live, and I shall place you in your own land: then shall ye know that I the LORD have spoken it, and performed it, saith the LORD."

Ezekiel 37:3-14 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/ezk.37.3-14.KJV>

10) What does God tell Ezekial to do? Was Ezekial obedient to God's command?

11) What was the result of Ezekial's speaking of God's words?

"And wherever the river goes, every living creature that swarms will live, and there will be very many fish. For this water goes there, that the waters of the sea may become fresh; so everything will live where the river goes."

Ezekiel 47:9 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/ezk.47.9.ESV>

“And it shall come to pass, that every thing that liveth, which moveth, whithersoever the rivers shall come, shall live: and there shall be a very great multitude of fish, because these waters shall come thither: for they shall be healed; and every thing shall live whither the river cometh.”
Ezekiel 47:9 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/ezk.47.9.KJV>

Also see *Day 40: Visions of life from God described by Ezekial* from my book [“God’s Love Plan in Jesus and the Church: 40 Days in the Old Testament”](#)

“For thus says the Lord to the house of Israel: “Seek me and live; but do not seek Bethel, and do not enter into Gilgal or cross over to Beersheba; for Gilgal shall surely go into exile, and Bethel shall come to nothing.” Seek the Lord and live, lest he break out like fire in the house of Joseph, and it devour, with none to quench it for Bethel, ...Seek good, and not evil, that you may live; and so the Lord, the God of hosts, will be with you, as you have said.”

Amos 5:4-6, 14 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/amo.5.4-14.ESV>

“For thus saith the LORD unto the house of Israel, Seek ye me, and ye shall live: but seek not Beth-el, nor enter into Gilgal, and pass not to Beer-sheba: for Gilgal shall surely go into captivity, and Beth-el shall come to nought. Seek the LORD, and ye shall live; lest he break out like fire in the house of Joseph, and devour it, and there be none to quench it in Beth-el... Seek good, and not evil, that ye may live: and so the LORD, the God of hosts, shall be with you, as ye have spoken.”

Amos 5:4-6, 14 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/amo.5.4-14.KJV>

12) What are we to seek after, that we might live?

13) In what ways are we to do this?

“Behold, his soul is puffed up; it is not upright within him, but the righteous shall live by his faith.”

Habakkuk 2:4 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/hab.2.4.ESV>

“Behold, his soul which is lifted up is not upright in him: but the just shall live by his faith.”

Habakkuk 2:4 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/hab.2.4.KJV>

14) What does it mean that the righteous shall live by his faith?

H2416, Chay, live

“then the Lord God formed the man of dust from the ground and breathed into his nostrils the breath of life, and the man became a living creature. And the Lord God planted a garden in Eden, in the east, and there he put the man whom he had formed. And out of the ground the Lord God made to spring up every tree that is pleasant to the sight and good for food. The tree of life was in the midst of the garden, and the tree of the knowledge of good and evil.”

Genesis 2:7-9 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/gen.2.7-9.ESV>

“And the LORD God formed man of the dust of the ground, and breathed into his nostrils the breath of life; and man became a living soul. And the LORD God planted a garden eastward in Eden; and there he put the man whom he had formed. And out of the ground made the LORD God to grow every tree that is pleasant to the sight, and good for food; the tree of life also in the midst of the garden, and the tree of knowledge of good and evil.”

Genesis 2:7-9 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/gen.2.7-9.KJV>

Note: Biblical references to life in the gospels and John’s epistles are not cited in this book since they are cited in Chapter 3 and the Appendix of my book [“Jesus’ words of love, light, and life”](#)

G2222, Zōē, life

“And when Peter saw it he addressed the people: “Men of Israel, why do you wonder at this, or why do you stare at us, as though by our own power or piety we have made him walk? The God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob, the God of our fathers, glorified his servant Jesus, whom you delivered over and denied in the presence of Pilate, when he had decided to release him. But you denied the Holy and Righteous One, and asked for a murderer to be granted to you, and you killed the Author of life, whom God raised from the dead. To this we are witnesses. And his name—by faith in his name—has made this man strong whom you see and know, and the faith that is through Jesus has given the man this perfect health in the presence of you all.”

Acts 3:12-16 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/act.3.12-16.ESV>

“And when Peter saw it, he answered unto the people, Ye men of Israel, why marvel ye at this? or why look ye so earnestly on us, as though by our own power or holiness we had made this man to walk? The God of Abraham, and of Isaac, and of Jacob, the God of our fathers, hath glorified his Son Jesus; whom ye delivered up, and denied him in the presence of Pilate, when he was determined to let him go. But ye denied the Holy One and the Just, and desired a murderer to be granted unto you; and killed the Prince of life, whom God hath raised from the dead; whereof we are witnesses. And his name through faith in his name hath made this man strong, whom ye see and know: yea, the faith which is by him hath given him this perfect soundness in the presence of you all.”

Acts 3:12-16 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/act.3.12-16.KJV>

15) What does it mean for Jesus Christ to be the Author (or Prince) of life?

16) What was it that made the lame man strong so that he could walk?

“So Paul, standing in the midst of the Areopagus, said: “Men of Athens, I perceive that in every way you are very religious. For as I passed along and observed the objects of your worship, I found also an altar with this inscription: ‘To the unknown god.’ What therefore you worship as unknown, this I proclaim to you. The God who made the world and everything in it, being Lord of heaven and earth, does not live in temples made by man, nor is he served by human hands, as though he needed anything, since he himself gives to all mankind life and breath and everything. And he made from one man every nation of mankind to live on all the face of the earth, having determined allotted periods and the boundaries of their dwelling place, that they should seek God, and perhaps feel their way toward him and find him. Yet he is actually not far from each one of us, for “‘In him we live and move and have our being’; as even some of your own poets have said, “‘For we are indeed his offspring.’ Being then God’s offspring, we ought not to think that the divine being is like gold or silver or stone, an image formed by the art and imagination of man. The times of ignorance God overlooked, but now he commands all people everywhere to repent, because he has fixed a day on which he will judge the world in righteousness by a man whom he has appointed; and of this he has given assurance to all by raising him from the dead.””

Acts 17:22-31 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/act.17.22-31.ESV>

“Then Paul stood in the midst of Mars' hill, and said, Ye men of Athens, I perceive that in all things ye are too superstitious. For as I passed by, and beheld your devotions, I found an altar with this inscription, TO THE UNKNOWN GOD. Whom therefore ye ignorantly worship, him declare I unto you. God that made the world and all things therein, seeing that he is Lord of heaven and earth, dwelleth not in temples made with hands; neither is worshipped with men's hands, as though he needed any thing, seeing he giveth to all life, and breath, and all things; and hath made of one blood all nations of men for to dwell on all the face of the earth, and hath determined the times before appointed, and the bounds of their habitation; that they should seek the Lord, if haply they might feel after him, and find him, though he be not far from every one of us: for in him we live, and move, and have our being; as certain also of your own poets have said, For we are also his offspring. Forasmuch then as we are the offspring of God, we ought not to think that the Godhead is like unto gold, or silver, or stone, graven by art and man's device. And the times of this ignorance God winked at; but now commandeth all men everywhere to repent: because he hath appointed a day, in the which he will judge the world in righteousness by that man whom he hath ordained; whereof he hath given assurance unto all men, in that he hath raised him from the dead.”

Acts 17:22-31 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/act.17.22-31.KJV>

17) How did Paul describe God as the source of life as we know it?

18) What does God require of all of mankind?

“But now that you have been set free from sin and have become slaves of God, the fruit you get leads to sanctification and its end, eternal life. For the wages of sin is death, but the free gift of God is eternal life in Christ Jesus our Lord.”

Romans 6:22-23 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/rom.6.22-23.ESV>

“But now being made free from sin, and become servants to God, ye have your fruit unto holiness, and the end everlasting life. For the wages of sin is death; but the gift of God is eternal life through Jesus Christ our Lord.”

Romans 6:22-23 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/rom.6.22-23.KJV>

19) What is the gift of God described in this passage?

20) How is this gift received?

“For the law of the Spirit of life has set you free in Christ Jesus from the law of sin and death... For those who live according to the flesh set their minds on the things of the flesh, but those who live according to the Spirit set their minds on the things of the Spirit. For to set the mind on the flesh is death, but to set the mind on the Spirit is life and peace.”

Romans 8:2, 5-6 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/rom.8.2-6.ESV>

“For the law of the Spirit of life in Christ Jesus hath made me free from the law of sin and death... For they that are after the flesh do mind the things of the flesh; but they that are after the Spirit the things of the Spirit. For to be carnally minded is death; but to be spiritually minded is life and peace.”

Romans 8:2, 5-6 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/rom.8.2-6.KJV>

21) What is the law of the Spirit of life?

22) What does it mean to be set free in Christ Jesus from the law of sin and death?

23) What does it mean to be spiritually minded? How does it bring life? Is your life full of life (zōē) and peace?

“But thanks be to God, who in Christ always leads us in triumphal procession, and through us spreads the fragrance of the knowledge of him everywhere. For we are the aroma of Christ to God among those who are being saved and among those who are perishing, to one a fragrance from death to death, to the other a fragrance from life to life. Who is sufficient for these things?”

2 Corinthians 2:14-16 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/2co.2.14-16.ESV>

“Now thanks be unto God, which always causeth us to triumph in Christ, and maketh manifest the savour of his knowledge by us in every place. For we are unto God a sweet savour of Christ,

in them that are saved, and in them that perish: to the one we are the savour of death unto death; and to the other the savour of life unto life. And who is sufficient for these things?"

2 Corinthians 2:14-16 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/2co.2.14-16.KJV>

24) What does it mean to be led in a triumphal procession by Christ? To always triumph in Christ?

25) In Christ, how do we bring life to others?

"But we have this treasure in jars of clay, to show that the surpassing power belongs to God and not to us. We are afflicted in every way, but not crushed; perplexed, but not driven to despair; persecuted, but not forsaken; struck down, but not destroyed; always carrying in the body the death of Jesus, so that the life of Jesus may also be manifested in our bodies. For we who live are always being given over to death for Jesus' sake, so that the life of Jesus also may be manifested in our mortal flesh."

2 Corinthians 4:7-11 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/2co.4.7-11.ESV>

"But we have this treasure in earthen vessels, that the excellency of the power may be of God, and not of us. We are troubled on every side, yet not distressed; we are perplexed, but not in despair; persecuted, but not forsaken; cast down, but not destroyed; always bearing about in the body the dying of the Lord Jesus, that the life also of Jesus might be made manifest in our body. For we which live are alway delivered unto death for Jesus' sake, that the life also of Jesus might be made manifest in our mortal flesh."

2 Corinthians 4:7-11 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/2co.4.7-11.KJV>

26) What treasure do we bear in jars of clay (or earthen vessels)?

27) How is the life of Jesus made manifest in our body (or bodies and mortal flesh)?

"For we know that if the tent that is our earthly home is destroyed, we have a building from God, a house not made with hands, eternal in the heavens. For in this tent we groan, longing to put on our heavenly dwelling, if indeed by putting it on we may not be found naked. For while we are still in this tent, we groan, being burdened—not that we would be unclothed, but that we would be further clothed, so that what is mortal may be swallowed up by life. He who has prepared us for this very thing is God, who has given us the Spirit as a guarantee."

2 Corinthians 5:1-5 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/2co.5.1-5.ESV>

"For we know that if our earthly house of this tabernacle were dissolved, we have a building of God, an house not made with hands, eternal in the heavens. For in this we groan, earnestly desiring to be clothed upon with our house which is from heaven: if so be that being clothed we shall not be found naked. For we that are in this tabernacle do groan, being burdened: not for that we would be unclothed, but clothed upon, that mortality might be swallowed up of life. Now

he that hath wrought us for the selfsame thing is God, who also hath given unto us the earnest of the Spirit.”

2 Corinthians 5:1-5 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/2co.5.1-5.KJV>

28) What does it mean to be swallowed up by life?

29) Of what is the Spirit that lives in us an earnest (or guarantee)?

“Do not be deceived: God is not mocked, for whatever one sows, that will he also reap. For the one who sows to his own flesh will from the flesh reap corruption, but the one who sows to the Spirit will from the Spirit reap eternal life. And let us not grow weary of doing good, for in due season we will reap, if we do not give up. So then, as we have opportunity, let us do good to everyone, and especially to those who are of the household of faith.”

Galatians 6:7-10 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/gal.6.7-10.ESV>

“Be not deceived; God is not mocked: for whatsoever a man soweth, that shall he also reap. For he that soweth to his flesh shall of the flesh reap corruption; but he that soweth to the Spirit shall of the Spirit reap life everlasting. And let us not be weary in well doing: for in due season we shall reap, if we faint not. As we have therefore opportunity, let us do good unto all men, especially unto them who are of the household of faith.”

Galatians 6:7-10 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/gal.6.7-10.KJV>

30) What does it mean to sow to the Spirit?

31) What does it mean to reap life?

“Now this I say and testify in the Lord, that you must no longer walk as the Gentiles do, in the futility of their minds. They are darkened in their understanding, alienated from the life of God because of the ignorance that is in them, due to their hardness of heart.”

Ephesians 4:17-18 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/eph.4.17-18.ESV>

“This I say therefore, and testify in the Lord, that ye henceforth walk not as other Gentiles walk, in the vanity of their mind, having the understanding darkened, being alienated from the life of God through the ignorance that is in them, because of the blindness of their heart:”

Ephesians 4:17-18 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/eph.4.17-18.KJV>

32) Why is it so important that as believers we have our minds renewed to the Word of God?

“If then you have been raised with Christ, seek the things that are above, where Christ is, seated at the right hand of God. Set your minds on things that are above, not on things that are

on earth. For you have died, and your life is hidden with Christ in God. When Christ who is your life appears, then you also will appear with him in glory.”

Colossians 3:1-4 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/col.3.1-4.ESV>

“If ye then be risen with Christ, seek those things which are above, where Christ sitteth on the right hand of God. Set your affection on things above, not on things on the earth. For ye are dead, and your life is hid with Christ in God. When Christ, who is our life, shall appear, then shall ye also appear with him in glory.”

Colossians 3:1-4 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/col.3.1-4.KJV>

33) What does it mean that your life is hid with Christ in God?

34) How do we set our minds (and affection) on things above?

“As for the rich in this present age, charge them not to be haughty, nor to set their hopes on the uncertainty of riches, but on God, who richly provides us with everything to enjoy. They are to do good, to be rich in good works, to be generous and ready to share, thus storing up treasure for themselves as a good foundation for the future, so that they may take hold of that which is truly life.”

1 Timothy 6:17-19 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1ti.6.17-19.ESV>

“Charge them that are rich in this world, that they be not highminded, nor trust in uncertain riches, but in the living God, who giveth us richly all things to enjoy; that they do good, that they be rich in good works, ready to distribute, willing to communicate; laying up in store for themselves a good foundation against the time to come, that they may lay hold on eternal life.”

1 Timothy 6:17-19 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/1ti.6.17-19.KJV>

35) How may those who are rich take hold of the fullness of life that God offers?

“Come now, you who say, “Today or tomorrow we will go into such and such a town and spend a year there and trade and make a profit”— yet you do not know what tomorrow will bring. What is your life? For you are a mist that appears for a little time and then vanishes. Instead you ought to say, “If the Lord wills, we will live and do this or that.” As it is, you boast in your arrogance. All such boasting is evil. So whoever knows the right thing to do and fails to do it, for him it is sin.”

James 4:13-17 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/jas.4.13-17.ESV>

“Go to now, ye that say, To day or to morrow we will go into such a city, and continue there a year, and buy and sell, and get gain: whereas ye know not what shall be on the morrow. For what is your life? It is even a vapour, that appeareth for a little time, and then vanisheth away. For that ye ought to say, If the Lord will, we shall live, and do this, or that. But now ye rejoice in

your boastings: all such rejoicing is evil. Therefore to him that knoweth to do good, and doeth it not, to him it is sin.”

James 4:13-17 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/jas.4.13-17.KJV>

36) Why should our focus in life be on doing right (or doing good) on the day that is at hand?

“May grace and peace be multiplied to you in the knowledge of God and of Jesus our Lord. His divine power has granted to us all things that pertain to life and godliness, through the knowledge of him who called us to his own glory and excellence, by which he has granted to us his precious and very great promises, so that through them you may become partakers of the divine nature, having escaped from the corruption that is in the world because of sinful desire.”

2 Peter 1:2-4 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/2pe.1.2-4.ESV>

“grace and peace be multiplied unto you through the knowledge of God, and of Jesus our Lord, according as his divine power hath given unto us all things that pertain unto life and godliness, through the knowledge of him that hath called us to glory and virtue: whereby are given unto us exceeding great and precious promises: that by these ye might be partakers of the divine nature, having escaped the corruption that is in the world through lust.”

2 Peter 1:2-4 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/2pe.1.2-4.KJV>

37) What does it mean to have been granted by God all things that pertain to life and godliness? Given exceeding great and precious promises?

38) What does it mean for us to have become partakers of the divine nature?

G2198, Zaō, living

““Men, why are you doing these things? We also are men, of like nature with you, and we bring you good news, that you should turn from these vain things to a living God, who made the heaven and the earth and the sea and all that is in them.”

Acts 14:15 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/act.14.15.ESV>

“and saying, Sirs, why do ye these things? We also are men of like passions with you, and preach unto you that ye should turn from these vanities unto the living God, which made heaven, and earth, and the sea, and all things that are therein:”

Acts 14:15 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/act.14.15.KJV>

“For I am not ashamed of the gospel, for it is the power of God for salvation to everyone who believes, to the Jew first and also to the Greek. For in it the righteousness of God is revealed from faith for faith, as it is written, “The righteous shall live by faith.””

Romans 1:16-17 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/rom.1.16-17.ESV>

“For I am not ashamed of the gospel of Christ: for it is the power of God unto salvation to every one that believeth; to the Jew first, and also to the Greek. For therein is the righteousness of God revealed from faith to faith: as it is written, The just shall live by faith.”

Romans 1:16-17 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/rom.1.16-17.KJV>

39) In what ways is the the gospel of Christ the power of God unto salvation?

40) How is the righteousness of God revealed by the gospel? What does this have to do with faith?

41) What does it mean for the righteous (or just) to live by faith?

“Do not be unequally yoked with unbelievers. For what partnership has righteousness with lawlessness? Or what fellowship has light with darkness? What accord has Christ with Belial? Or what portion does a believer share with an unbeliever? What agreement has the temple of God with idols? For we are the temple of the living God; as God said, “I will make my dwelling among them and walk among them, and I will be their God, and they shall be my people.

Therefore go out from their midst, and be separate from them, says the Lord, and touch no unclean thing; then I will welcome you, and I will be a father to you, and you shall be sons and daughters to me, says the Lord Almighty.”

2 Corinthians 6:14-18 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/2co.6.14-18.ESV>

“Be ye not unequally yoked together with unbelievers: for what fellowship hath righteousness with unrighteousness? and what communion hath light with darkness? And what concord hath Christ with Belial? or what part hath he that believeth with an infidel? And what agreement hath the temple of God with idols? for ye are the temple of the living God; as God hath said, I will dwell in them, and walk in them; and I will be their God, and they shall be my people. Wherefore Come out from among them, and be ye separate, saith the Lord, And touch not the unclean thing; And I will receive you, And will be a Father unto you, And ye shall be my sons and daughters, saith the Lord Almighty.”

2 Corinthians 6:14-18 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/2co.6.14-18.KJV>

42) What does it mean to be unequally yoked with unbelievers? How will you avoid this?

43) What does it mean that we as God’s church are the temple of the living God? What are the implications of this?

44) What does it mean that God dwells in us and walks in us? What are the implications of this?

45) Why must we lead holy lives? How are we to lead holy lives?

46) In what sense are we sons and daughters of God? What are the implications of this?

“since you seek proof that Christ is speaking in me. He is not weak in dealing with you, but is powerful among you. For he was crucified in weakness, but lives by the power of God. For we also are weak in him, but in dealing with you we will live with him by the power of God. Examine yourselves, to see whether you are in the faith. Test yourselves. Or do you not realize this about yourselves, that Jesus Christ is in you?—unless indeed you fail to meet the test!”

2 Corinthians 13:3-5 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/2co.13.3-5.ESV>

“since ye seek a proof of Christ speaking in me, which to you-ward is not weak, but is mighty in you. For though he was crucified through weakness, yet he liveth by the power of God. For we also are weak in him, but we shall live with him by the power of God toward you. Examine yourselves, whether ye be in the faith; prove your own selves. Know ye not your own selves, how that Jesus Christ is in you, except ye be reprobates?”

2 Corinthians 13:3-5 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/2co.13.3-5.KJV>

47) How does Jesus Christ live in us? What is being communicated about the power of God?

48) How are we to examine ourselves?

“For through the law I died to the law, so that I might live to God. I have been crucified with Christ. It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me. And the life I now live in the flesh I live by faith in the Son of God, who loved me and gave himself for me.”

Galatians 2:19-20 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/gal.2.19-20.ESV>

“For I through the law am dead to the law, that I might live unto God. I am crucified with Christ: nevertheless I live; yet not I, but Christ liveth in me: and the life which I now live in the flesh I live by the faith of the Son of God, who loved me, and gave himself for me.”

Galatians 2:19-20 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/gal.2.19-20.KJV>

49) How did Christ live in Paul? Is this a model for us?

For more on this, see my book [*Experiencing Christ in Paul*](#)

“For all who rely on works of the law are under a curse; for it is written, “Cursed be everyone who does not abide by all things written in the Book of the Law, and do them.” Now it is evident that no one is justified before God by the law, for “The righteous shall live by faith.” But the law is not of faith, rather “The one who does them shall live by them.” Christ redeemed us from the curse of the law by becoming a curse for us—for it is written, “Cursed is everyone who is hanged on a tree”— so that in Christ Jesus the blessing of Abraham might come to the Gentiles, so that we might receive the promised Spirit through faith.”

Galatians 3:10-14 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/gal.3.10-14.ESV>

“For as many as are of the works of the law are under the curse: for it is written, Cursed is every one that continueth not in all things which are written in the book of the law to do them. But that no man is justified by the law in the sight of God, it is evident: for, The just shall live by faith. And the law is not of faith: but, The man that doeth them shall live in them. Christ hath redeemed us from the curse of the law, being made a curse for us: for it is written, Cursed is every one that hangeth on a tree: that the blessing of Abraham might come on the Gentiles through Jesus Christ; that we might receive the promise of the Spirit through faith.”

Galatians 3:10-14 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/gal.3.10-14.KJV>

50) What do we receive through faith?

“But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, self-control; against such things there is no law. And those who belong to Christ Jesus have crucified the flesh with its passions and desires. If we live by the Spirit, let us also keep in step with the Spirit.”

Galatians 5:22-25 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/gal.5.22-25.ESV>

“But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, longsuffering, gentleness, goodness, faith, meekness, temperance: against such there is no law. And they that are Christ's have crucified the flesh with the affections and lusts. If we live in the Spirit, let us also walk in the Spirit.”

Galatians 5:22-25 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/gal.5.22-25.KJV>

51) What does it mean to live in the Spirit?

“For to me to live is Christ, and to die is gain.”

Philippians 1:21 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/php.1.21.ESV>

“For to me to live is Christ, and to die is gain.”

Philippians 1:21 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/php.1.21.KJV>

52) What did Paul mean when he wrote, “to live is Christ”?

“since you have been born again, not of perishable seed but of imperishable, through the living and abiding word of God;”

1 Peter 1:23 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1pe.1.23.ESV>

“being born again, not of corruptible seed, but of incorruptible, by the word of God, which liveth and abideth for ever.”

1 Peter 1:23 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/1pe.1.23.KJV>

53) In what sense is the word of God living? How does it relate to being born again?

“He himself bore our sins in his body on the tree, that we might die to sin and live to righteousness. By his wounds you have been healed.”

1 Peter 2:24 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1pe.2.24.ESV>

“who his own self bare our sins in his own body on the tree, that we, being dead to sins, should live unto righteousness: by whose stripes ye were healed.”

1 Peter 2:24 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/1pe.2.24.KJV>

54) What does it mean to live to righteousness?

55) In what way are we healed by His stripes?

G2227, Ζῳοποιεῖν, quicken

“That is why it depends on faith, in order that the promise may rest on grace and be guaranteed to all his offspring—not only to the adherent of the law but also to the one who shares the faith of Abraham, who is the father of us all, as it is written, “I have made you the father of many nations”—in the presence of the God in whom he believed, who gives life to the dead and calls into existence the things that do not exist.”

Romans 4:16-17 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/rom.4.16-17.ESV>

“Therefore it is of faith, that it might be by grace; to the end the promise might be sure to all the seed; not to that only which is of the law, but to that also which is of the faith of Abraham; who is the father of us all, (as it is written, I have made thee a father of many nations,) before him whom he believed, even God, who quickeneth the dead, and calleth those things which be not as though they were.”

Romans 4:16-17 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/rom.4.16-17.KJV>

56) How does God call things into existence that do not exist?

57) How does God quicken the dead?

“If the Spirit of him who raised Jesus from the dead dwells in you, he who raised Christ Jesus from the dead will also give life to your mortal bodies through his Spirit who dwells in you.”

Romans 8:11 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/rom.8.11.ESV>

“But if the Spirit of him that raised up Jesus from the dead dwell in you, he that raised up Christ from the dead shall also quicken your mortal bodies by his Spirit that dwelleth in you.”

Romans 8:11 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/rom.8.11.KJV>

58) How does the indwelling Spirit quicken our mortal bodies?

“You yourselves are our letter of recommendation, written on our hearts, to be known and read by all. And you show that you are a letter from Christ delivered by us, written not with ink but with the Spirit of the living God, not on tablets of stone but on tablets of human hearts. Such is the confidence that we have through Christ toward God. Not that we are sufficient in ourselves to claim anything as coming from us, but our sufficiency is from God, who has made us sufficient to be ministers of a new covenant, not of the letter but of the Spirit. For the letter kills, but the Spirit gives life.”

2 Corinthians 3:2-6 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/2co.3.2-6.ESV>

“Ye are our epistle written in our hearts, known and read of all men: forasmuch as ye are manifestly declared to be the epistle of Christ ministered by us, written not with ink, but with the Spirit of the living God; not in tables of stone, but in fleshy tables of the heart. And such trust have we through Christ to God-ward: not that we are sufficient of ourselves to think any thing as of ourselves; but our sufficiency is of God; who also hath made us able ministers of the new testament; not of the letter, but of the spirit: for the letter killeth, but the spirit giveth life.”

2 Corinthians 3:2-6 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/2co.3.2-6.KJV>

59) How does the Spirit of the living God give life?

60) How are we to be ministers of the new covenant (or testament)?

“For Christ also suffered once for sins, the righteous for the unrighteous, that he might bring us to God, being put to death in the flesh but made alive in the spirit,”

1 Peter 3:18 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1pe.3.18.ESV>

“For Christ also hath once suffered for sins, the just for the unjust, that he might bring us to God, being put to death in the flesh, but quickened by the Spirit:”

1 Peter 3:18 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/1pe.3.18.KJV>

61) In what ways are we quickened by the Spirit?

62) How does the pursuit of life apart from Christ drive us directly away from the same?

63) How do we receive life by actively cooperating with the indwelling Spirit of God to form the fullness of Christ in us?

64) How may we receive life when we actively cooperate with the indwelling Spirit of God to form the fullness of Christ in us and within Christ's body?

Chapter 2: Liberty

Since we have the Spirit of the Lord in us, we have the liberty the Spirit brings. It is not a liberty to do as we please, which brings bondage and death, but instead liberty from the law of sin and death. In Christ, we have been set free from serving ourselves, allowing us opportunities to serve one another out of the kind of benevolent love God has engendered in our hearts. Further, we are at liberty to cooperate with God's own Spirit to see that God's will is done on earth as it is in heaven. Together we carry on Christ's anointing to proclaim liberty to the captives and the opening of the prison to those who are bound.

Selected words in scripture

Liberty

H1865

Transliteration: Derôr

Pronunciation: der-ore'

BDB Lexicon:

1. A flowing, free run, liberty
 - a. Flowing (of myrrh)
 - b. liberty

Also translated as pure

Loose

H5425

Transliteration: nâthar

Pronunciation: naw-thar'

BDB Lexicon:

1. To start up, tremble, shake, spring up
 - a. To start up
 - b. To leap
 - c. To cause to start up
2. To loose, let loose, undo, be free, be loose
 - a. To unfasten, loose
 - b. To set free, unbind

Liberty

G1657

Transliteration: Eleutheria

Pronounced: el-yoo-ther-ee'-ah

Thayer Lexicon:

1. Liberty to do or to omit things having no relationship to salvation
2. Fancied liberty
 - a. License, the liberty to do as one pleases
3. True liberty is living as we should not as we please

To free

G1658

Transliteration: Eleutheros

Thayer Lexicon:

1. Freeborn
 - a. In a civil sense, one who is not a slave
 - b. Of one who ceases to be a slave, freed, manumitted
2. Free, exempt, unrestrained, not bound by obligation
3. In an ethical sense: free from the yoke of the Mosaic Law

Also translated as free woman, at liberty, free man

Make free

G1659

Transliteration: Eleutheroō

Pronunciation: el-yoo-ther-o'-o

Thayer Lexicon:

1. To make free
2. Set at liberty: from the dominion of sin

Also translated as deliver

Liberty

G859

Transliteration: Aphesis

Pronunciation: af'-es-is

Thayer Lexicon:

1. Release from bondage or imprisonment
2. Forgiveness or pardon, of sins (letting them go as if they had never been committed), remission of the penalty

Also translated as remission, forgiveness, deliverance

Liberty

G1849

Transliteration: Exousia

Pronunciation: ex-oo-see'-ah

Thayer Lexicon:

1. Power of choice, liberty of doing as one pleases
 - a. Leave or permission
2. Physical and mental power
 - a. The ability or strength with which one is endued, which he either possesses or exercises
3. The power of authority (influence) and of right (privilege)
4. The power of rule or government (the power of him whose will and commands must be submitted to by others and obeyed)

- a. Universally
 - i. Authority over mankind
 - b. Specifically
 - i. The power of judicial decisions
 - ii. Of authority to manage domestic affairs
 - c. Metonymically
 - i. A thing subject to authority or rule
 - 1. Jurisdiction
 - ii. One who possesses authority
 - 1. A ruler, human magistrate
 - 2. The leading and more powerful among created beings superior to man, spiritual potentates
 - d. A sign of the husband's authority over this wife
 - i. The veil with which propriety required a woman to cover herself
 - e. The sign of regal authority, a crown
- Also translated as power, authority, right, jurisdiction, strength

Selected scriptures and questions for meditation

H1865, Derôr, liberty

“And you shall consecrate the fiftieth year, and proclaim liberty throughout the land to all its inhabitants. It shall be a jubilee for you, when each of you shall return to his property and each of you shall return to his clan.”

Leviticus 25:10 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/lev.25.10.ESV>

“And ye shall hallow the fiftieth year, and proclaim liberty throughout all the land unto all the inhabitants thereof: it shall be a jubile unto you; and ye shall return every man unto his possession, and ye shall return every man unto his family.”

Leviticus 25:10 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/lev.25.10.KJV>

- 1) What does God's institution of the year of jubilee say about Him and His character? What does it say about how God sees the worth of individuals?
- 2) Do you think the year of jubilee, when practiced, was disruptive to those with better social status? Did it provide better opportunities to those without such status?

“The Spirit of the Lord God is upon me, because the Lord has anointed me to bring good news to the poor; he has sent me to bind up the brokenhearted, to proclaim liberty to the captives, and the opening of the prison to those who are bound;”

Isaiah 61:1 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/isa.61.1.ESV>

“The Spirit of the Lord GOD is upon me; because the LORD hath anointed me to preach good tidings unto the meek; he hath sent me to bind up the brokenhearted, to proclaim liberty to the captives, and the opening of the prison to them that are bound;”

Isaiah 61:1 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/isa.61.1.KJV>

3) Jesus applied this Scripture to himself and His ministry, the Spirit of the Lord upon Him. Since Jesus has given us (anointed us with) the Holy Spirit, does it apply also to us?

4) In the context of Christ's ministry (and even the apostles' ministry), what does it mean to proclaim liberty to the captives, and the opening of the prison to them that are bound?

H5425, Nâthar, loose

“Blessed is he whose help is the God of Jacob, whose hope is in the Lord his God, who made heaven and earth, the sea, and all that is in them, who keeps faith forever; who executes justice for the oppressed, who gives food to the hungry. The Lord sets the prisoners free; the Lord opens the eyes of the blind. The Lord lifts up those who are bowed down; the Lord loves the righteous. The Lord watches over the sojourners; he upholds the widow and the fatherless, but the way of the wicked he brings to ruin.”

Psalms 146:5-9 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/psa.146.5-9.ESV>

“Happy is he that hath the God of Jacob for his help, Whose hope is in the LORD his God: Which made heaven, and earth, the sea, and all that therein is: Which keepeth truth for ever: Which executeth judgment for the oppressed: Which giveth food to the hungry. The LORD looseth the prisoners: The LORD openeth the eyes of the blind: The LORD raiseth them that are bowed down: The LORD loveth the righteous: The LORD preserveth the strangers; He relieveth the fatherless and widow: But the way of the wicked he turneth upside down.”

Psalms 146:5-9 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/psa.146.5-9.KJV>

5) How is God's beautiful nature described in this passage?

6) Which described attributes were characteristic of Jesus Christ?

7) Which described attributes of God are characteristic of any who have God's Spirit?

““Is not this the fast that I choose: to loose the bonds of wickedness, to undo the straps of the yoke, to let the oppressed go free, and to break every yoke? Is it not to share your bread with the hungry and bring the homeless poor into your house; when you see the naked, to cover him, and not to hide yourself from your own flesh? Then shall your light break forth like the dawn, and your healing shall spring up speedily; your righteousness shall go before you; the glory of the Lord shall be your rear guard. Then you shall call, and the Lord will answer; you shall cry, and he will say, ‘Here I am.’ If you take away the yoke from your midst, the pointing of the finger, and speaking wickedness, if you pour yourself out for the hungry and satisfy the desire of the afflicted, then shall your light rise in the darkness and your gloom be as the noonday. And the

Lord will guide you continually and satisfy your desire in scorched places and make your bones strong; and you shall be like a watered garden, like a spring of water, whose waters do not fail. And your ancient ruins shall be rebuilt; you shall raise up the foundations of many generations; you shall be called the repairer of the breach, the restorer of streets to dwell in.”

Isaiah 58:6-12 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/isa.58.6-12.ESV>

“Is not this the fast that I have chosen? to loose the bands of wickedness, to undo the heavy burdens, and to let the oppressed go free, and that ye break every yoke? Is it not to deal thy bread to the hungry, and that thou bring the poor that are cast out to thy house? when thou seest the naked, that thou cover him; and that thou hide not thyself from thine own flesh? Then shall thy light break forth as the morning, and thine health shall spring forth speedily: and thy righteousness shall go before thee; the glory of the LORD shall be thy rereward. Then shalt thou call, and the LORD shall answer; thou shalt cry, and he shall say, Here I am. If thou take away from the midst of thee the yoke, the putting forth of the finger, and speaking vanity; and if thou draw out thy soul to the hungry, and satisfy the afflicted soul; then shall thy light rise in obscurity, and thy darkness be as the noon day: and the LORD shall guide thee continually, and satisfy thy soul in drought, and make fat thy bones: and thou shalt be like a watered garden, and like a spring of water, whose waters fail not. And they that shall be of thee shall build the old waste places: thou shalt raise up the foundations of many generations; and thou shalt be called, The repairer of the breach, The restorer of paths to dwell in.”

Isaiah 58:6-12 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/isa.58.6-12.KJV>

8) What actions that we as God's people could take does God find to be pleasing and righteous, according to this passage?

9) Which of these righteous acts have to do with bringing liberty?

10) In what practical ways can we do some of these things?

11) How can we together as God's church do all of these things to bring God glory?

12) What are some of the benefits of following God in these ways, according to this passage?

G1657, Eleutheria, liberty

“For I consider that the sufferings of this present time are not worth comparing with the glory that is to be revealed to us. For the creation waits with eager longing for the revealing of the sons of God. For the creation was subjected to futility, not willingly, but because of him who subjected it, in hope that the creation itself will be set free from its bondage to corruption and obtain the freedom of the glory of the children of God.”

Romans 8:18-21 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/rom.8.18-21.ESV>

“For I reckon that the sufferings of this present time are not worthy to be compared with the glory which shall be revealed in us. For the earnest expectation of the creature waiteth for the manifestation of the sons of God. For the creature was made subject to vanity, not willingly, but

by reason of him who hath subjected the same in hope, because the creature itself also shall be delivered from the bondage of corruption into the glorious liberty of the children of God.”

Romans 8:18-21 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/rom.8.18-21.KJV>

13) What deliverance is being described at the end of this passage?

14) What is the manifestation of the sons of God?

“Since we have such a hope, we are very bold, not like Moses, who would put a veil over his face so that the Israelites might not gaze at the outcome of what was being brought to an end. But their minds were hardened. For to this day, when they read the old covenant, that same veil remains unlifted, because only through Christ is it taken away. Yes, to this day whenever Moses is read a veil lies over their hearts. But when one turns to the Lord, the veil is removed. Now the Lord is the Spirit, and where the Spirit of the Lord is, there is freedom. And we all, with unveiled face, beholding the glory of the Lord, are being transformed into the same image from one degree of glory to another. For this comes from the Lord who is the Spirit.”

2 Corinthians 3:12-18 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/2co.3.12-18.ESV>

“Seeing then that we have such hope, we use great plainness of speech: and not as Moses, which put a vail over his face, that the children of Israel could not stedfastly look to the end of that which is abolished: but their minds were blinded: for until this day remaineth the same vail untaken away in the reading of the old testament; which vail is done away in Christ. But even unto this day, when Moses is read, the vail is upon their heart. Nevertheless when it shall turn to the Lord, the vail shall be taken away. Now the Lord is that Spirit: and where the Spirit of the Lord is, there is liberty. But we all, with open face beholding as in a glass the glory of the Lord, are changed into the same image from glory to glory, even as by the Spirit of the Lord.”

2 Corinthians 3:12-18 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/2co.3.12-18.KJV>

15) In what ways are we to be very bold?

16) How does the Spirit of the Lord bring liberty (or freedom)?

17) What does it mean to be transformed into the same image from one degree of glory to another?

18) How are we transformed?

“Yet because of false brothers secretly brought in—who slipped in to spy out our freedom that we have in Christ Jesus, so that they might bring us into slavery—”

Galatians 2:4 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/gal.2.4.ESV>

“and that because of false brethren unawares brought in, who came in privily to spy out our liberty which we have in Christ Jesus, that they might bring us into bondage.”

Galatians 2:4 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/gal.2.4.KJV>

19) Describe the liberty we have in Christ Jesus.

“For freedom Christ has set us free; stand firm therefore, and do not submit again to a yoke of slavery.”

Galatians 5:1 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/gal.5.1.ESV>

“Stand fast therefore in the liberty wherewith Christ hath made us free, and be not entangled again with the yoke of bondage.”

Galatians 5:1 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/gal.5.1.KJV>

20) How do we stand fast in the liberty wherewith Christ has made us free?

21) What does it mean to submit again to a yoke of slavery (or bondage)?

“For you were called to freedom, brothers. Only do not use your freedom as an opportunity for the flesh, but through love serve one another. For the whole law is fulfilled in one word: “You shall love your neighbor as yourself.””

Galatians 5:13-14 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/gal.5.13-14.ESV>

“For, brethren, ye have been called unto liberty; only use not liberty for an occasion to the flesh, but by love serve one another. For all the law is fulfilled in one word, even in this; Thou shalt love thy neighbour as thyself.”

Galatians 5:13-14 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/gal.5.13-14.KJV>

22) In what way have we been called to liberty?

23) How would we use our liberty as an opportunity for the flesh?

24) Whom are we supposed to serve in love?

25) In what ways may you use your liberty to love your neighbor as yourself today?

“But the one who looks into the perfect law, the law of liberty, and perseveres, being no hearer who forgets but a doer who acts, he will be blessed in his doing.”

James 1:25 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/jas.1.25.ESV>

“But whoso looketh into the perfect law of liberty, and continueth therein, he being not a forgetful hearer, but a doer of the work, this man shall be blessed in his deed.”

James 1:25 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/jas.1.25.KJV>

- 26) How does doing the word of God bring liberty?
- 27) How are we blessed or made happy by doing God's word?
- 28) How may you come to do more of God's word?
- 29) How may you encourage your local church (or churches) to unite together in doing God's word?

"Live as people who are free, not using your freedom as a cover-up for evil, but living as servants of God."

1 Peter 2:16 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1pe.2.16.ESV>

"as free, and not using your liberty for a cloke of maliciousness, but as the servants of God."

1 Peter 2:16 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/1pe.2.16.KJV>

- 30) How would one use their liberty in Christ as a cover-up for evil?
- 31) In what ways may we use our freedom to serve?

G1658, Eleutheros, to free

"So Jesus said to the Jews who had believed him, 'If you abide in my word, you are truly my disciples, and you will know the truth, and the truth will set you free.' They answered him, 'We are offspring of Abraham and have never been enslaved to anyone. How is it that you say, 'You will become free'?' Jesus answered them, 'Truly, truly, I say to you, everyone who practices sin is a slave to sin. The slave does not remain in the house forever; the son remains forever. So if the Son sets you free, you will be free indeed.'"

John 8:31-36 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/jhn.8.31-36.ESV>

"Then said Jesus to those Jews which believed on him, If ye continue in my word, then are ye my disciples indeed; and ye shall know the truth, and the truth shall make you free. They answered him, We be Abraham's seed, and were never in bondage to any man: how sayest thou, Ye shall be made free? Jesus answered them, Verily, verily, I say unto you, Whosoever committeth sin is the servant of sin. And the servant abideth not in the house for ever: but the Son abideth ever. If the Son therefore shall make you free, ye shall be free indeed."

John 8:31-36 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/jhn.8.31-36.KJV>

- 32) What does it mean to abide in Jesus' word?
- 33) Do you abide in Jesus' word?
- 34) Has God's truth set you free?
- 35) Do you live as one set free?
- 36) Are you still a slave in any way?
- 37) Are you determined to be free? To bring God's freedom to others?

38) How may you bring the liberty that Christ has made available to others?

“For though I am free from all, I have made myself a servant to all, that I might win more of them. To the Jews I became as a Jew, in order to win Jews. To those under the law I became as one under the law (though not being myself under the law) that I might win those under the law. To those outside the law I became as one outside the law (not being outside the law of God but under the law of Christ) that I might win those outside the law. To the weak I became weak, that I might win the weak. I have become all things to all people, that by all means I might save some. I do it all for the sake of the gospel, that I may share with them in its blessings.”

1 Corinthians 9:19-23 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1co.9.19-23.ESV>

“For though I be free from all men, yet have I made myself servant unto all, that I might gain the more. And unto the Jews I became as a Jew, that I might gain the Jews; to them that are under the law, as under the law, that I might gain them that are under the law; to them that are without law, as without law, (being not without law to God, but under the law to Christ,) that I might gain them that are without law. To the weak became I as weak, that I might gain the weak: I am made all things to all men, that I might by all means save some. And this I do for the gospel's sake, that I might be partaker thereof with you.”

1 Corinthians 9:19-23 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/1co.9.19-23.KJV>

39) What does it look like for one to voluntarily make oneself a servant to all?

40) What do we gain by freely serving others? What did Paul look to gain by serving the different people groups he served?

41) What does it mean to be made all things to all men?

42) How do you view your stewardship of the gospel?

G1659, Eleutheroō, make free

“For the law of the Spirit of life has set you free in Christ Jesus from the law of sin and death.”

Romans 8:2 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/rom.8.2.ESV>

“For the law of the Spirit of life in Christ Jesus hath made me free from the law of sin and death.”

Romans 8:2 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/rom.8.2.KJV>

43) What's the law of the Spirit of life?

44) What does it mean to be made free from the law of sin and death?

45) How has the Spirit of life made you free from the law of sin and death?

46) How can you be part of bringing freedom to others? How will you?

G859, Aphasis, liberty

“And he came to Nazareth, where he had been brought up. And as was his custom, he went to the synagogue on the Sabbath day, and he stood up to read. And the scroll of the prophet Isaiah was given to him. He unrolled the scroll and found the place where it was written, “The Spirit of the Lord is upon me, because he has anointed me to proclaim good news to the poor. He has sent me to proclaim liberty to the captives and recovering of sight to the blind, to set at liberty those who are oppressed, to proclaim the year of the Lord’s favor.””

Luke 4:16-19 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.4.16-19.ESV>

“And he came to Nazareth, where he had been brought up: and, as his custom was, he went into the synagogue on the sabbath day, and stood up for to read. And there was delivered unto him the book of the prophet Esaias. And when he had opened the book, he found the place where it was written, The Spirit of the Lord is upon me, Because he hath anointed me to preach the gospel to the poor; He hath sent me to heal the brokenhearted, to preach deliverance to the captives, And recovering of sight to the blind, To set at liberty them that are bruised, To preach the acceptable year of the Lord.”

Luke 4:16-19 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.4.16-19.KJV>

47) When did the Spirit of the Lord come upon Jesus, anointing Him?

48) How did Jesus heal the brokenhearted?

49) How did Jesus preach deliverance to the captives?

50) How did Jesus set at liberty those who were oppressed (or bruised)?

51) What is the acceptable year of the Lord (or the year of His favor)?

52) Since Christ gave God’s Spirit to you (and the church), what part of this anointing is yours (ours)?

53) What are you doing to continue Christ’s ministry that sets others at liberty? What is your local church doing?

G1849, Exousia, liberty

“And I said, ‘Who are you, Lord?’ And the Lord said, ‘I am Jesus whom you are persecuting. But rise and stand upon your feet, for I have appeared to you for this purpose, to appoint you as a servant and witness to the things in which you have seen me and to those in which I will appear to you, delivering you from your people and from the Gentiles—to whom I am sending you to open their eyes, so that they may turn from darkness to light and from the power of Satan to God, that they may receive forgiveness of sins and a place among those who are sanctified by faith in me.’”

Acts 26:15-18 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/act.26.15-18.ESV>

“And I said, Who art thou, Lord? And he said, I am Jesus whom thou persecutest. But rise, and stand upon thy feet: for I have appeared unto thee for this purpose, to make thee a minister and

a witness both of these things which thou hast seen, and of those things in the which I will appear unto thee; delivering thee from the people, and from the Gentiles, unto whom now I send thee, to open their eyes, and to turn them from darkness to light, and from the power of Satan unto God, that they may receive forgiveness of sins, and inheritance among them which are sanctified by faith that is in me.”

Acts 26:15-18 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/act.26.15-18.KJV>

54) How did Jesus describe the Apostle Paul's ministry of the gospel?

55) How does following Jesus Christ bring liberty, according to Jesus' words to Paul?

56) How do you want to be part of bringing such liberty to those to whom God is sending you?

57) How may you live as one who is sent where God has placed you now?

58) How may your church live as those sent to the community that it touches?

“Food will not commend us to God. We are no worse off if we do not eat, and no better off if we do. But take care that this right of yours does not somehow become a stumbling block to the weak.”

1 Corinthians 8:8-9 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1co.8.8-9.ESV>

“But meat commendeth us not to God: for neither, if we eat, are we the better; neither, if we eat not, are we the worse. But take heed lest by any means this liberty of your's become a stumblingblock to them that are weak.”

1 Corinthians 8:8-9 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/1co.8.8-9.KJV>

59) Although we have such liberty in Christ, how may we best avoid putting stumbling blocks in the way of other believers, given differences in thought and belief?

“And you were dead in the trespasses and sins in which you once walked, following the course of this world, following the prince of the power of the air, the spirit that is now at work in the sons of disobedience— among whom we all once lived in the passions of our flesh, carrying out the desires of the body and the mind, and were by nature children of wrath, like the rest of mankind.”

Ephesians 2:1-3 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/eph.2.1-3.ESV>

“And you hath he quickened, who were dead in trespasses and sins; wherein in time past ye walked according to the course of this world, according to the prince of the power of the air, the spirit that now worketh in the children of disobedience: among whom also we all had our conversation in times past in the lusts of our flesh, fulfilling the desires of the flesh and of the mind; and were by nature the children of wrath, even as others.”

Ephesians 2:1-3 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/eph.2.1-3.KJV>

- 60) How is our bondage before being born again described in this passage?
- 61) Is this description of bondage consistent with how you view those who do not follow Jesus Christ?
- 62) How does new life in Christ free and transform us out of this former state?

“giving thanks to the Father, who has qualified you to share in the inheritance of the saints in light. He has delivered us from the domain of darkness and transferred us to the kingdom of his beloved Son,”

Colossians 1:12-13 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/col.1.12-13.ESV>

“giving thanks unto the Father, which hath made us meet to be partakers of the inheritance of the saints in light: who hath delivered us from the power of darkness, and hath translated us into the kingdom of his dear Son:”

Colossians 1:12-13 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/col.1.12-13.KJV>

- 63) What does it mean to be delivered from the domain (or power) of darkness?
- 64) What is the kingdom of God? How are you part of it now?
- 65) How are you now a partaker of the inheritance of the saints? What part of your inheritance available to you now are you not yet partaking in?

Chapter 3: Happiness

As Solomon conveys in Ecclesiastes, the things of this world are as a vapor. Our pursuit of them outside of a first love for God and a desire to see His will done brings only disappointment. Yet, in Christ, when we decide to align our will with God's, to seek His kingdom, to hunger after His own righteousness, and to consistently do God's word, the result is that we are blessed and happy. This is living a life led by the Spirit of God. The words for blessed in Hebrew and Greek both mean happy as well, as God's blessing and our enduring happiness come together. Happiness is the result of actively cooperating with the indwelling Spirit of God to form the fullness of Christ in us, for which we have been predestined. Nothing and no one can take it away.

Selected words in scripture

Happy

H835

Transliteration: 'Esher

Pronunciation: eh'-sher

BDB Lexicon:

1. Happiness, blessedness
 - a. Often used an interjection
 - b. Blessed are

Also translated as blessed

Blessed

G3107

Transliteration: makarios

Pronunciation: mak-ar'-ee-os

Thayer Lexicon:

1. Blessed, happy

Also translated as happy, happier

Selected scriptures and questions for meditation

H835, 'Esher, happy

“Behold, blessed is the one whom God reproves; therefore despise not the discipline of the Almighty.”

Job 5:17 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/job.5.17.ESV>

“Behold, happy is the man whom God correcteth: Therefore despise not thou the chastening of the Almighty.”

Job 5:17 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/job.5.17.KJV>

1) How may God's correction of one yield blessing and happiness?

"Blessed is the man who walks not in the counsel of the wicked, nor stands in the way of sinners, nor sits in the seat of scoffers;"

Psalms 1:1 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/psa.1.1.ESV>

"Blessed is the man that walketh not in the counsel of the ungodly, nor standeth in the way of sinners, Nor sitteth in the seat of the scornful."

Psalms 1:1 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/psa.1.1.KJV>

2) How may keeping company with the ungodly, scoffers, and sinners affect your happiness?

"Blessed is the nation whose God is the Lord, the people whom he has chosen as his heritage!"

Psalms 33:12 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/psa.33.12.ESV>

"Blessed is the nation whose God is the LORD; And the people whom he hath chosen for his own inheritance."

Psalms 33:12 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/psa.33.12.KJV>

3) How may belonging to God's people affect one's blessedness and happiness?

"Oh, taste and see that the Lord is good! Blessed is the man who takes refuge in him!"

Psalms 34:8 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/psa.34.8.ESV>

"O taste and see that the LORD is good: Blessed is the man that trusteth in him."

Psalms 34:8 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/psa.34.8.KJV>

4) How may your choices to see God's goodness, trust God and take refuge in God affect your happiness?

"Blessed is the man who makes the Lord his trust, who does not turn to the proud, to those who go astray after a lie!"

Psalms 40:4 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/psa.40.4.ESV>

“Blessed is that man that maketh the LORD his trust, And respecteth not the proud, nor such as turn aside to lies.”

Psalm 40:4 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/psa.40.4.KJV>

5) How may your abilities to understand God’s truth, reject lies, and depend first on God affect your happiness?

“Blessed is the one who considers the poor! In the day of trouble the Lord delivers him;”

Psalm 41:1 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/psa.41.1.ESV>

“Blessed is he that considereth the poor: The LORD will deliver him in time of trouble.”

Psalm 41:1 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/psa.41.1.KJV>

6) How may your obedience to God’s commands to consider and care for the poor affect the blessing and help you receive from God?

“Blessed is the one you choose and bring near, to dwell in your courts! We shall be satisfied with the goodness of your house, the holiness of your temple!”

Psalm 65:4 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/psa.65.4.ESV>

“Blessed is the man whom thou choosest, and causest to approach unto thee, That he may dwell in thy courts: We shall be satisfied with the goodness of thy house, even of thy holy temple.”

Psalm 65:4 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/psa.65.4.KJV>

7) How do our actions that affect whether we abide in Christ influence our happiness?

“Blessed are those who dwell in your house, ever singing your praise! Selah Blessed are those whose strength is in you, in whose heart are the highways to Zion... O Lord of hosts, blessed is the one who trusts in you!”

Psalm 84:4-5, 12 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/psa.84.4-12.ESV>

“Blessed are they that dwell in thy house: They will be still praising thee. Selah. Blessed is the man whose strength is in thee; In whose heart are the ways of them... O LORD of hosts, Blessed is the man that trusteth in thee.”

Psalm 84:4-5, 12 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/psa.84.4-12.KJV>

- 8) Is a persistent attitude of praise characteristic of abiding in Christ?
9) How do we draw strength from our connection to God?

“Blessed is the man whom you discipline, O Lord, and whom you teach out of your law,”

Psalms 94:12 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/psa.94.12.ESV>

“Blessed is the man whom thou chastenest, O LORD, And teachest him out of thy law;”

Psalms 94:12 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/psa.94.12.KJV>

- 10) How does God teach us?

“Blessed are they who observe justice, who do righteousness at all times!”

Psalms 106:3 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/psa.106.3.ESV>

“Blessed are they that keep judgment, And he that doeth righteousness at all times.”

Psalms 106:3 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/psa.106.3.KJV>

- 11) How do you spend time ensuring that right is being done in your world? Are there other opportunities for you to contribute to bringing about righteousness?

- 12) How does your church contribute to making things right in your community, according to what would please God?

“Praise the Lord! Blessed is the man who fears the Lord, who greatly delights in his commandments! His offspring will be mighty in the land; the generation of the upright will be blessed. Wealth and riches are in his house, and his righteousness endures forever. Light dawns in the darkness for the upright; he is gracious, merciful, and righteous. It is well with the man who deals generously and lends; who conducts his affairs with justice. For the righteous will never be moved; he will be remembered forever. He is not afraid of bad news; his heart is firm, trusting in the Lord. His heart is steady; he will not be afraid, until he looks in triumph on his adversaries. He has distributed freely; he has given to the poor; his righteousness endures forever; his horn is exalted in honor.”

Psalms 112:1-9 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/psa.112.1-9.ESV>

“Praise ye the LORD. Blessed is the man that feareth the LORD, That delighteth greatly in his commandments. His seed shall be mighty upon earth: The generation of the upright shall be blessed. Wealth and riches shall be in his house: And his righteousness endureth for ever. Unto the upright there ariseth light in the darkness: He is gracious, and full of compassion, and righteous. A good man sheweth favour, and lendeth: He will guide his affairs with discretion. Surely he shall not be moved for ever: The righteous shall be in everlasting remembrance. He

shall not be afraid of evil tidings: His heart is fixed, trusting in the LORD. His heart is established, he shall not be afraid, Until he see his desire upon his enemies. He hath dispersed, he hath given to the poor; His righteousness endureth for ever; His horn shall be exalted with honour.”

Psalms 112:1-9 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/psa.112.1-9.KJV>

- 13) What does it mean to fear the Lord? Do you fear Him?
- 14) Do you delight in God's word? How so?
- 15) What characteristics of the righteous are described in this passage?
- 16) How does God bless the righteous?
- 17) How are we to react to bad news? Are we to fear others outside of God?

“Blessed are those whose way is blameless, who walk in the law of the Lord! Blessed are those who keep his testimonies, who seek him with their whole heart, who also do no wrong, but walk in his ways!”

Psalms 119:1-3 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/psa.119.1-3.ESV>

“Blessed are the undefiled in the way, Who walk in the law of the LORD. Blessed are they that keep his testimonies, And that seek him with the whole heart. They also do no iniquity: They walk in his ways.”

Psalms 119:1-3 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/psa.119.1-3.KJV>

- 18) Do you seek God with your whole heart?
- 19) Is God your first love? Are you steadfast in your love? What else in your life competes with your love for God?
- 20) Do you believe that the Holy Spirit who dwells in you (Christ in you) empowers you to live in a righteous and Christlike way?
- 21) What does it look like for one to walk as Christ walked?
- 22) Do you live in a right and Christlike way? To what extent do you walk as Christ walked?
- 23) Are you disciplined or mentored by a believer who walks in a way that is even more Christlike? Do you disciple others?

“Behold, children are a heritage from the Lord, the fruit of the womb a reward. Like arrows in the hand of a warrior are the children of one's youth. Blessed is the man who fills his quiver with them! He shall not be put to shame when he speaks with his enemies in the gate.”

Psalms 127:3-5 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/psa.127.3-5.ESV>

“Lo, children are an heritage of the LORD: And the fruit of the womb is his reward. As arrows are in the hand of a mighty man; So are children of the youth. Happy is the man that hath his

quiver full of them: They shall not be ashamed, but they shall speak with the enemies in the gate.”

Psalms 127:3-5 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/psa.127.3-5.KJV>

24) If you have children, do you see them as described in this passage? How are they described?

25) How are godly children as arrows?

26) How may your children make you happy?

“Blessed is everyone who fears the Lord, who walks in his ways! You shall eat the fruit of the labor of your hands; you shall be blessed, and it shall be well with you. Your wife will be like a fruitful vine within your house; your children will be like olive shoots around your table. Behold, thus shall the man be blessed who fears the Lord.”

Psalms 128:1-4 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/psa.128.1-4.ESV>

“Blessed is every one that feareth the LORD; That walketh in his ways. For thou shalt eat the labour of thine hands: Happy shalt thou be, and it shall be well with thee. Thy wife shall be as a fruitful vine by the sides of thine house: Thy children like olive plants round about thy table. Behold, that thus shall the man be blessed that feareth the LORD.”

Psalms 128:1-4 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/psa.128.1-4.KJV>

27) How does walking in God’s ways bring blessing and happiness?

“May our sons in their youth be like plants full grown, our daughters like corner pillars cut for the structure of a palace; may our granaries be full, providing all kinds of produce; may our sheep bring forth thousands and ten thousands in our fields; may our cattle be heavy with young, suffering no mishap or failure in bearing; may there be no cry of distress in our streets! Blessed are the people to whom such blessings fall! Blessed are the people whose God is the Lord!”

Psalms 144:12-15 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/psa.144.12-15.ESV>

“That our sons may be as plants grown up in their youth; That our daughters may be as corner stones, polished after the similitude of a palace: That our garners may be full, affording all manner of store: That our sheep may bring forth thousands and ten thousands in our streets: That our oxen may be strong to labour; That there be no breaking in, nor going out; That there be no complaining in our streets. Happy is that people, that is in such a case: Yea, happy is that people, whose God is the LORD.”

Psalms 144:12-15 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/psa.144.12-15.KJV>

28) How does this passage describe the blessing and happiness of people who have made Christ Lord?

29) What does it mean to have God our Lord?

“Put not your trust in princes, in a son of man, in whom there is no salvation. When his breath departs, he returns to the earth; on that very day his plans perish. Blessed is he whose help is the God of Jacob, whose hope is in the Lord his God, who made heaven and earth, the sea, and all that is in them, who keeps faith forever; who executes justice for the oppressed, who gives food to the hungry. The Lord sets the prisoners free; the Lord opens the eyes of the blind. The Lord lifts up those who are bowed down; the Lord loves the righteous. The Lord watches over the sojourners; he upholds the widow and the fatherless, but the way of the wicked he brings to ruin.”

Psalm 146:3-9 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/psa.146.3-9.ESV>

“Put not your trust in princes, nor in the son of man, In whom there is no help. His breath goeth forth, he returneth to his earth; In that very day his thoughts perish. Happy is he that hath the God of Jacob for his help, Whose hope is in the LORD his God: Which made heaven, and earth, the sea, and all that therein is: Which keepeth truth for ever: Which executeth judgment for the oppressed: Which giveth food to the hungry. The LORD looseth the prisoners: The LORD openeth the eyes of the blind: The LORD raiseth them that are bowed down: The LORD loveth the righteous: The LORD preserveth the strangers; He relieveth the fatherless and widow: But the way of the wicked he turneth upside down.”

Psalm 146:3-9 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/psa.146.3-9.KJV>

30) Why should we not trust in man(kind)? Do you trust in men (over God) in anything?

31) Do you trust in God for your help?

32) In what or whom have you placed your hope?

33) How is the goodness of God described in this passage?

34) Do you believe God wants to do good to you in every circumstance? Do you believe He is willing?

35) Which good characteristics of God described here are also characteristics of you, Christ in you? Which are characteristic of your local church as a whole?

“Blessed is the one who finds wisdom, and the one who gets understanding, for the gain from her is better than gain from silver and her profit better than gold. She is more precious than jewels, and nothing you desire can compare with her. Long life is in her right hand; in her left hand are riches and honor. Her ways are ways of pleasantness, and all her paths are peace. She is a tree of life to those who lay hold of her; those who hold her fast are called blessed.”

Proverbs 3:13-18 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/pro.3.13-18.ESV>

“Happy is the man that findeth wisdom, And the man that getteth understanding. For the merchandise of it is better than the merchandise of silver, And the gain thereof than fine gold. She is more precious than rubies: And all the things thou canst desire are not to be compared unto her. Length of days is in her right hand; And in her left hand riches and honour. Her ways are ways of pleasantness, And all her paths are peace. She is a tree of life to them that lay hold upon her: And happy is every one that retaineth her.”

Proverbs 3:13-18 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/pro.3.13-18.KJV>

36) How may wisdom and understanding make one happy and bring blessing?

37) How do you actively seek after godly wisdom and understanding? How has it brought you blessing so far?

“Whoever despises his neighbor is a sinner, but blessed is he who is generous to the poor.”

Proverbs 14:21 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/pro.14.21.ESV>

“He that despiseth his neighbour sinneth: But he that hath mercy on the poor, happy is he.”

Proverbs 14:21 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/pro.14.21.KJV>

38) Who are your neighbors?

39) Do you despise any of your neighbors?

40) How are you merciful and generous to the poor? How is your local church merciful and generous to the local poor? The poor in the world?

“Whoever gives thought to the word will discover good, and blessed is he who trusts in the Lord.”

Proverbs 16:20 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/pro.16.20.ESV>

“He that handleth a matter wisely shall find good: And whoso trusteth in the LORD, happy is he.”

Proverbs 16:20 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/pro.16.20.KJV>

“The righteous who walks in his integrity— blessed are his children after him!”

Proverbs 20:7 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/pro.20.7.ESV>

“The just man walketh in his integrity: His children are blessed after him.”

Proverbs 20:7 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/pro.20.7.KJV>

41) How may our integrity bless and make our children happy?

42) How may our lack of integrity accomplish the opposite?

“Where there is no prophetic vision the people cast off restraint, but blessed is he who keeps the law.”

Proverbs 29:18 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/pro.29.18.ESV>

“Where there is no vision, the people perish: But he that keepeth the law, happy is he.”

Proverbs 29:18 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/pro.29.18.KJV>

43) How does attention to keeping and doing God’s word bring blessing?

“Therefore the Lord waits to be gracious to you, and therefore he exalts himself to show mercy to you. For the Lord is a God of justice; blessed are all those who wait for him.”

Isaiah 30:18 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/isa.30.18.ESV>

“And therefore will the LORD wait, that he may be gracious unto you, and therefore will he be exalted, that he may have mercy upon you: for the LORD is a God of judgment: blessed are all they that wait for him.”

Isaiah 30:18 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/isa.30.18.KJV>

44) What does it mean to wait for God? What should we expect from Him?

G3107, Makarios, blessed

““Blessed are the poor in spirit, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven. “Blessed are those who mourn, for they shall be comforted. “Blessed are the meek, for they shall inherit the earth. “Blessed are those who hunger and thirst for righteousness, for they shall be satisfied. “Blessed are the merciful, for they shall receive mercy. “Blessed are the pure in heart, for they shall see God. “Blessed are the peacemakers, for they shall be called sons of God. “Blessed are those who are persecuted for righteousness’ sake, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven. “Blessed are you when others revile you and persecute you and utter all kinds of evil against you falsely on my account. Rejoice and be glad, for your reward is great in heaven, for so they persecuted the prophets who were before you.”

Matthew 5:3-12 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.5.3-12.ESV>

“Blessed are the poor in spirit: for their's is the kingdom of heaven. Blessed are they that mourn: for they shall be comforted. Blessed are the meek: for they shall inherit the earth. Blessed are they which do hunger and thirst after righteousness: for they shall be filled. Blessed are the merciful: for they shall obtain mercy. Blessed are the pure in heart: for they shall see God.

Blessed are the peacemakers: for they shall be called the children of God. Blessed are they which are persecuted for righteousness' sake: for their's is the kingdom of heaven. Blessed are ye, when men shall revile you, and persecute you, and shall say all manner of evil against you falsely, for my sake. Rejoice, and be exceeding glad: for great is your reward in heaven: for so persecuted they the prophets which were before you."

Matthew 5:3-12 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.5.3-12.KJV>

- 45) How does this passage describe our progression in righteousness and in maturity toward Christlikeness?
- 46) What does it mean to be poor in spirit?
- 47) What is the kingdom of heaven? Is it ours now?
- 48) Over what should a new believer mourn? How will they receive comfort?
- 49) What does it mean to be meek?
- 50) What is it to hunger and thirst after righteousness? Could this be right results in the world?
- 51) To what extent do you hunger and thirst after righteousness? How about your local church?
- 52) How are you merciful to others? How about your church?
- 53) Why do the pure in heart better see God? How pure is your heart?
- 54) Are you a peacemaker? How do you go about bringing God's peace?
- 55) Are you persecuted, reviled, or spoken poorly of for righteousness' sake, as Christ and His disciples were?
- 56) Does it make sense to you to rejoice in such treatment? Why or why not?
- 57) What level of visibility or types of action on your part (and your church's part), do you imagine, would result in a greater association by others of your main cause to be with Christ and God's righteousness?

"And Jesus answered them, "Go and tell John what you hear and see: the blind receive their sight and the lame walk, lepers are cleansed and the deaf hear, and the dead are raised up, and the poor have good news preached to them. And blessed is the one who is not offended by me."

Matthew 11:4-6 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.11.4-6.ESV>

"Jesus answered and said unto them, Go and shew John again those things which ye do hear and see: the blind receive their sight, and the lame walk, the lepers are cleansed, and the deaf hear, the dead are raised up, and the poor have the gospel preached to them. And blessed is he, whosoever shall not be offended in me."

Matthew 11:4-6 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.11.4-6.KJV>

- 58) Why does Jesus' ministry cause offense to some?
- 59) Do any parts of Jesus' ministry make you uneasy?

“For this people’s heart has grown dull, and with their ears they can barely hear, and their eyes they have closed, lest they should see with their eyes and hear with their ears and understand with their heart and turn, and I would heal them.’ But blessed are your eyes, for they see, and your ears, for they hear.”

Matthew 13:15-16 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.13.15-16.ESV>

“For this people's heart is waxed gross, And their ears are dull of hearing, And their eyes they have closed; Lest at any time they should see with their eyes, And hear with their ears, And should understand with their heart, And should be converted, and I should heal them. But blessed are your eyes, for they see: and your ears, for they hear.”

Matthew 13:15-16 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.13.15-16.KJV>

60) How are we blessed when we can sense and give attention to God’s words, thoughts and purpose?

“He said to them, “But who do you say that I am?” Simon Peter replied, “You are the Christ, the Son of the living God.” And Jesus answered him, “Blessed are you, Simon Bar-Jonah! For flesh and blood has not revealed this to you, but my Father who is in heaven. And I tell you, you are Peter, and on this rock I will build my church, and the gates of hell shall not prevail against it. I will give you the keys of the kingdom of heaven, and whatever you bind on earth shall be bound in heaven, and whatever you loose on earth shall be loosed in heaven.””

Matthew 16:15-19 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.16.15-19.ESV>

“He saith unto them, But whom say ye that I am? And Simon Peter answered and said, Thou art the Christ, the Son of the living God. And Jesus answered and said unto him, Blessed art thou, Simon Bar-jona: for flesh and blood hath not revealed it unto thee, but my Father which is in heaven. And I say also unto thee, That thou art Peter, and upon this rock I will build my church; and the gates of hell shall not prevail against it. And I will give unto thee the keys of the kingdom of heaven: and whatsoever thou shalt bind on earth shall be bound in heaven: and whatsoever thou shalt loose on earth shall be loosed in heaven.”

Matthew 16:15-19 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.16.15-19.KJV>

61) How are we blessed by correctly recognizing the Lordship of the living Christ?

62) How are we blessed by the strength of our faith in Jesus Christ?

63) How are we blessed by recognizing and using the keys of the kingdom of heaven, binding and loosing? How may this affect one’s happiness?

“And he lifted up his eyes on his disciples, and said: “Blessed are you who are poor, for yours is the kingdom of God. “Blessed are you who are hungry now, for you shall be satisfied. “Blessed are you who weep now, for you shall laugh. “Blessed are you when people hate you and when

they exclude you and revile you and spurn your name as evil, on account of the Son of Man! Rejoice in that day, and leap for joy, for behold, your reward is great in heaven; for so their fathers did to the prophets.”

Luke 6:20-23 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.6.20-23.ESV>

“And he lifted up his eyes on his disciples, and said, Blessed be ye poor: for your's is the kingdom of God. Blessed are ye that hunger now: for ye shall be filled. Blessed are ye that weep now: for ye shall laugh. Blessed are ye, when men shall hate you, and when they shall separate you from their company, and shall reproach you, and cast out your name as evil, for the Son of man's sake. Rejoice ye in that day, and leap for joy: for, behold, your reward is great in heaven: for in the like manner did their fathers unto the prophets.”

Luke 6:20-23 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.6.20-23.KJV>

“In that hour he healed many people of diseases and plagues and evil spirits, and on many who were blind he bestowed sight. And he answered them, “Go and tell John what you have seen and heard: the blind receive their sight, the lame walk, lepers are cleansed, and the deaf hear, the dead are raised up, the poor have good news preached to them. And blessed is the one who is not offended by me.””

Luke 7:21-23 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.7.21-23.ESV>

“And in that same hour he cured many of their infirmities and plagues, and of evil spirits; and unto many that were blind he gave sight. Then Jesus answering said unto them, Go your way, and tell John what things ye have seen and heard; how that the blind see, the lame walk, the lepers are cleansed, the deaf hear, the dead are raised, to the poor the gospel is preached. And blessed is he, whosoever shall not be offended in me.”

Luke 7:21-23 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.7.21-23.KJV>

“The seventy-two returned with joy, saying, “Lord, even the demons are subject to us in your name!” And he said to them, “I saw Satan fall like lightning from heaven. Behold, I have given you authority to tread on serpents and scorpions, and over all the power of the enemy, and nothing shall hurt you. Nevertheless, do not rejoice in this, that the spirits are subject to you, but rejoice that your names are written in heaven.” Then turning to the disciples he said privately, “Blessed are the eyes that see what you see!”

Luke 10:17-20, 23 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.10.17-23.ESV>

“And the seventy returned again with joy, saying, Lord, even the devils are subject unto us through thy name. And he said unto them, I beheld Satan as lightning fall from heaven. Behold, I give unto you power to tread on serpents and scorpions, and over all the power of the enemy: and nothing shall by any means hurt you. Notwithstanding in this rejoice not, that the spirits are

subject unto you; but rather rejoice, because your names are written in heaven. And he turned him unto his disciples, and said privately, Blessed are the eyes which see the things that ye see.”

Luke 10:17-20, 23 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.10.17-23.KJV>

64) What has Christ given to His disciples, according to this passage?

65) Why are we blessed to witness the defeat of evil by Christ's authority?

“But if it is by the finger of God that I cast out demons, then the kingdom of God has come upon you. When a strong man, fully armed, guards his own palace, his goods are safe; but when one stronger than he attacks him and overcomes him, he takes away his armor in which he trusted and divides his spoil... As he said these things, a woman in the crowd raised her voice and said to him, “Blessed is the womb that bore you, and the breasts at which you nursed!” But he said, “Blessed rather are those who hear the word of God and keep it!””

Luke 11:20-22, 27-28 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.11.20-28.ESV>

“But if I with the finger of God cast out devils, no doubt the kingdom of God is come upon you. When a strong man armed keepeth his palace, his goods are in peace: but when a stronger than he shall come upon him, and overcome him, he taketh from him all his armour wherein he trusted, and divideth his spoils... And it came to pass, as he spake these things, a certain woman of the company lifted up her voice, and said unto him, Blessed is the womb that bare thee, and the paps which thou hast sucked. But he said, Yea rather, blessed are they that hear the word of God, and keep it.”

Luke 11:20-22, 27-28 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.11.20-28.KJV>

66) Who is the stronger one who attacks and overcomes? Who is overcome?

67) What does it mean to keep the word of God? Which word are you careful to keep?

68) How does keeping God's word result in blessing and happiness?

““Stay dressed for action and keep your lamps burning, and be like men who are waiting for their master to come home from the wedding feast, so that they may open the door to him at once when he comes and knocks. Blessed are those servants whom the master finds awake when he comes. Truly, I say to you, he will dress himself for service and have them recline at table, and he will come and serve them. If he comes in the second watch, or in the third, and finds them awake, blessed are those servants! But know this, that if the master of the house had known at what hour the thief was coming, he would not have left his house to be broken into. You also must be ready, for the Son of Man is coming at an hour you do not expect.” Peter said, “Lord, are you telling this parable for us or for all?” And the Lord said, “Who then is the faithful and wise manager, whom his master will set over his household, to give them their portion of food at the proper time? Blessed is that servant whom his master will find so doing when he comes. Truly, I say to you, he will set him over all his possessions.”

Luke 12:35-44 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.12.35-44.ESV>

“Let your loins be girded about, and your lights burning; and ye yourselves like unto men that wait for their Lord, when he will return from the wedding; that when he cometh and knocketh, they may open unto him immediately. Blessed are those servants, whom the Lord when he cometh shall find watching: verily I say unto you, that he shall gird himself, and make them to sit down to meat, and will come forth and serve them. And if he shall come in the second watch, or come in the third watch, and find them so, blessed are those servants. And this know, that if the goodman of the house had known what hour the thief would come, he would have watched, and not have suffered his house to be broken through. Be ye therefore ready also: for the Son of man cometh at an hour when ye think not. Then Peter said unto him, Lord, speakest thou this parable unto us, or even to all? And the Lord said, Who then is that faithful and wise steward, whom his Lord shall make ruler over his household, to give them their portion of meat in due season? Blessed is that servant, whom his Lord when he cometh shall find so doing. Of a truth I say unto you, that he will make him ruler over all that he hath.”

Luke 12:35-44 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.12.35-44.KJV>

69) How are we to watch and wait for the Lord as His stewards?

70) How should we expect our readiness to affect our blessing?

“He said also to the man who had invited him, “When you give a dinner or a banquet, do not invite your friends or your brothers or your relatives or rich neighbors, lest they also invite you in return and you be repaid. But when you give a feast, invite the poor, the crippled, the lame, the blind, and you will be blessed, because they cannot repay you. For you will be repaid at the resurrection of the just.””

Luke 14:12-14 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.14.12-14.ESV>

“Then said he also to him that bade him, When thou makest a dinner or a supper, call not thy friends, nor thy brethren, neither thy kinsmen, nor thy rich neighbours; lest they also bid thee again, and a recompence be made thee. But when thou makest a feast, call the poor, the maimed, the lame, the blind: and thou shalt be blessed; for they cannot recompense thee: for thou shalt be recompensed at the resurrection of the just.”

Luke 14:12-14 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.14.12-14.KJV>

71) What blessing is to be found in your efforts to welcome the marginalized?

72) How well does your church welcome and care for the marginalized as Christ commanded?

How about other nonprofit organizations in your area?

“If I then, your Lord and Teacher, have washed your feet, you also ought to wash one another’s feet. For I have given you an example, that you also should do just as I have done to you. Truly,

truly, I say to you, a servant is not greater than his master, nor is a messenger greater than the one who sent him. If you know these things, blessed are you if you do them.”

John 13:14-17 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/jhn.13.14-17.ESV>

“If I then, your Lord and Master, have washed your feet; ye also ought to wash one another's feet. For I have given you an example, that ye should do as I have done to you. Verily, verily, I say unto you, The servant is not greater than his Lord; neither he that is sent greater than he that sent him. If ye know these things, happy are ye if ye do them.”

John 13:14-17 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/jhn.13.14-17.KJV>

73) As Christ's disciples, who are we supposed to serve?

74) How does serving others in Jesus' name bring happiness?

“Then he said to Thomas, “Put your finger here, and see my hands; and put out your hand, and place it in my side. Do not disbelieve, but believe.” Thomas answered him, “My Lord and my God!” Jesus said to him, “Have you believed because you have seen me? Blessed are those who have not seen and yet have believed.””

John 20:27-29 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/jhn.20.27-29.ESV>

“Then saith he to Thomas, Reach hither thy finger, and behold my hands; and reach hither thy hand, and thrust it into my side: and be not faithless, but believing. And Thomas answered and said unto him, My Lord and my God. Jesus saith unto him, Thomas, because thou hast seen me, thou hast believed: blessed are they that have not seen, and yet have believed.”

John 20:27-29 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/jhn.20.27-29.KJV>

75) How may our faith in the unseen affect our blessing from God and our happiness?

“I coveted no one's silver or gold or apparel. You yourselves know that these hands ministered to my necessities and to those who were with me. In all things I have shown you that by working hard in this way we must help the weak and remember the words of the Lord Jesus, how he himself said, ‘It is more blessed to give than to receive.’”

Acts 20:33-35 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/act.20.33-35.ESV>

“I have coveted no man's silver, or gold, or apparel. Yea, ye yourselves know, that these hands have ministered unto my necessities, and to them that were with me. I have shewed you all things, how that so labouring ye ought to support the weak, and to remember the words of the Lord Jesus, how he said, It is more blessed to give than to receive.”

Acts 20:33-35 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/act.20.33-35.KJV>

76) How does our benevolent giving, acting in line with God's own nature, bring blessing and happiness to us?

"Blessed is the man who remains steadfast under trial, for when he has stood the test he will receive the crown of life, which God has promised to those who love him."

James 1:12 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/jas.1.12.ESV>

"Blessed is the man that endureth temptation: for when he is tried, he shall receive the crown of life, which the Lord hath promised to them that love him."

James 1:12 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/jas.1.12.KJV>

77) How does our steadfastness in trial and temptation yield blessing and happiness in our lives?

"But be doers of the word, and not hearers only, deceiving yourselves. For if anyone is a hearer of the word and not a doer, he is like a man who looks intently at his natural face in a mirror. For he looks at himself and goes away and at once forgets what he was like. But the one who looks into the perfect law, the law of liberty, and perseveres, being no hearer who forgets but a doer who acts, he will be blessed in his doing."

James 1:22-25 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/jas.1.22-25.ESV>

"But be ye doers of the word, and not hearers only, deceiving your own selves. For if any be a hearer of the word, and not a doer, he is like unto a man beholding his natural face in a glass: for he beholdeth himself, and goeth his way, and straightway forgetteth what manner of man he was. But whoso looketh into the perfect law of liberty, and continueth therein, he being not a forgetful hearer, but a doer of the work, this man shall be blessed in his deed."

James 1:22-25 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/jas.1.22-25.KJV>

78) What does it mean to be a doer of the word? Which words?

79) How are we blessed and made happy by doing these things?

"Now who is there to harm you if you are zealous for what is good? But even if you should suffer for righteousness' sake, you will be blessed. Have no fear of them, nor be troubled,"

1 Peter 3:13-14 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1pe.3.13-14.ESV>

"And who is he that will harm you, if ye be followers of that which is good? But and if ye suffer for righteousness' sake, happy are ye: and be not afraid of their terror, neither be troubled;"

1 Peter 3:13-14 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/1pe.3.13-14.KJV>

80) In what ways do you do good? Are you zealous to do good?

81) Is your church zealous to do good?

82) Why is there happiness in suffering for doing right in Jesus' name?

"If you are insulted for the name of Christ, you are blessed, because the Spirit of glory and of God rests upon you."

1 Peter 4:14 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1pe.4.14.ESV>

"If ye be reproached for the name of Christ, happy are ye; for the spirit of glory and of God resteth upon you: on their part he is evil spoken of, but on your part he is glorified."

1 Peter 4:14 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/1pe.4.14.KJV>

83) How does God's indwelling Spirit bring blessing and happiness to us when we are obedient to Christ's call on our lives?

"The revelation of Jesus Christ, which God gave him to show to his servants the things that must soon take place. He made it known by sending his angel to his servant John, who bore witness to the word of God and to the testimony of Jesus Christ, even to all that he saw. Blessed is the one who reads aloud the words of this prophecy, and blessed are those who hear, and who keep what is written in it, for the time is near."

Revelation 1:1-3 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/rev.1.1-3.ESV>

"The Revelation of Jesus Christ, which God gave unto him, to shew unto his servants things which must shortly come to pass; and he sent and signified it by his angel unto his servant John: who bare record of the word of God, and of the testimony of Jesus Christ, and of all things that he saw. Blessed is he that readeth, and they that hear the words of this prophecy, and keep those things which are written therein: for the time is at hand."

Revelation 1:1-3 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/rev.1.1-3.KJV>

84) In what ways are we blessed by God's word, according to this passage?

"And I heard a voice from heaven saying, 'Write this: Blessed are the dead who die in the Lord from now on.' 'Blessed indeed,' says the Spirit, 'that they may rest from their labors, for their deeds follow them!'"

Revelation 14:13 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/rev.14.13.ESV>

“And I heard a voice from heaven saying unto me, Write, Blessed are the dead which die in the Lord from henceforth: Yea, saith the Spirit, that they may rest from their labours; and their works do follow them.”

Revelation 14:13 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/rev.14.13.KJV>

“Then I heard what seemed to be the voice of a great multitude, like the roar of many waters and like the sound of mighty peals of thunder, crying out, “Hallelujah! For the Lord our God the Almighty reigns. Let us rejoice and exult and give him the glory, for the marriage of the Lamb has come, and his Bride has made herself ready; it was granted her to clothe herself with fine linen, bright and pure”— for the fine linen is the righteous deeds of the saints. And the angel said to me, “Write this: Blessed are those who are invited to the marriage supper of the Lamb.” And he said to me, “These are the true words of God.””

Revelation 19:6-9 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/rev.19.6-9.ESV>

“And I heard as it were the voice of a great multitude, and as the voice of many waters, and as the voice of mighty thunderings, saying, Alleluia: for the Lord God omnipotent reigneth. Let us be glad and rejoice, and give honour to him: for the marriage of the Lamb is come, and his wife hath made herself ready. And to her was granted that she should be arrayed in fine linen, clean and white: for the fine linen is the righteousness of saints. And he saith unto me, Write, Blessed are they which are called unto the marriage supper of the Lamb. And he saith unto me, These are the true sayings of God.”

Revelation 19:6-9 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/rev.19.6-9.KJV>

““And behold, I am coming soon. Blessed is the one who keeps the words of the prophecy of this book.” ...Blessed are those who wash their robes, so that they may have the right to the tree of life and that they may enter the city by the gates.”

Revelation 22:7, 14 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/rev.22.7-14.ESV>

“Behold, I come quickly: blessed is he that keepeth the sayings of the prophecy of this book... Blessed are they that do his commandments, that they may have right to the tree of life, and may enter in through the gates into the city.”

Revelation 22:7, 14 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/rev.22.7-14.KJV>

85) How do you expect God to bless you and make you happy in the place prepared for you in heaven, based on God’s word and His goodness?